



08 – Daily Production Runbook & Call Sheet

*The repeatable operating manual for a single production day. The goal: **ship both segments, every weekday, without drama**. Consistency is the whole game (see the success ladder in [06](#)). Print the call sheet at the bottom each morning, or copy it into your calendar tool.*

Segments produced each day: ☀️ **Lunch Break Live** (10 min, live, ~12:00pm) · 🌙 **The Evening Show** (20 min, guest, evening drop). See format in [02](#); kit in [07](#).

The day at a glance

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8:30  Production standup (15 min) – lock the day
9:00  Story selection + Blow's Live prep
10:30  Evening Show guest prep + pre-call
11:30  ⚙️ TECH CHECK (hard stop – 30 min before air)
12:00  ☀️ LUNCH BREAK LIVE – GO LIVE (10 min)
12:15  Live debrief + editor starts pulling clips
1:00   Lunch / reset
2:00   🌙 EVENING SHOW record (or pull from bank)
3:00   Edit: Evening Show polish + clip cutting
5:00   Schedule clips · draft Daily Read · QC the Evening Show
6:30   🌙 EVENING SHOW publishes + clips queued
7:00   Community pass · set tomorrow's call sheet
```

Times are a template — shift the whole block to fit Blow's schedule. What matters is the **sequence and the hard stops**, not the clock.

Roles for the day

WHO	OWNS
Host (Charles Blow)	On-camera, editorial calls, the take, the guest
Producer / showrunner	Run-of-show, the clock, booking, the call sheet, "go/no-go"
Editor	Clip pipeline + Evening Show polish (the growth engine)
Live producer (or producer in P1)	Stream health, chat, lower-thirds, the countdown
Social/community (P1: producer)	Scheduling, captions, comment replies

In Phase 1 one or two people wear all hats. The runbook stays the same — just fewer hands.

Standup agenda (8:30, 15 min)

1. **Lunch Break Live story** — what's the one story? What's Blow's angle?
2. **Evening Show guest** — confirmed? Tech check time? Topic + 3 anchor questions?
3. **Clip targets** — any must-cut moments to watch for live?
4. **Risks** — connection, guest reliability, breaking-news pivot?
5. **Backup** — is the evergreen fallback episode ready if today breaks?

☀️ LUNCH BREAK LIVE – run of show (10 min, LIVE)

T-30 — Tech check (hard stop):

- ☐ Stream key live; OBS/Streamyard connected to YouTube (+ simulcast targets)
- ☐ Audio levels checked (mic, no clipping, no hum) — **the #1 thing**
- ☐ Lighting + framing locked; backdrop tidy
- ☐ Lower-third + title card loaded; "Subscribe" bug ready
- ☐ Internet: hardwired ethernet up; **hotspot backup on standby**
- ☐ Chat monitor on second screen; moderator ready
- ☐ Evergreen fallback clip queued in case the stream drops

On air (10:00):

TIME	BEAT
0:00–0:30	Animated open + cold welcome ("Here's what I'm watching today...")
0:30–7:00	The take — Blow's read on the day's biggest story (can include "The Receipts" / "The Throughline")
7:00–9:00	Live chat — react to 1–2 sharp audience questions
9:00–10:00	What Now? action + CTA: "Evening Show tonight with [guest] · subscribe / newsletter" + close card

The host's job: speed and clarity over polish. Live = human. If something breaks, narrate it and keep going.

THE EVENING SHOW — run of show (20 min, recorded)

Pre-call (T-30 before record):

- ☐ Guest mic/camera/lighting checked on Riverside (record **separate local tracks**)
- ☐ Backup audio recording running (phone/recorder) as insurance
- ☐ Names/titles confirmed for lower-thirds; pronunciation noted
- ☐ Blow's 3 anchor questions + 1 "What Now?" close ready
- ☐ Guest briefed: format, length, that it's clipped, the vibe (smart, not gotcha)

Record structure (~20 min):

TIME	BEAT
0:00–0:30	Open + guest intro (who they are, why now)
0:30–3:00	In Their Words — set the table, the human/origin hook
3:00–15:00	The conversation — the issue driving the news cycle; anchor questions + follow-ups
15:00–18:00	Devil's Advocate — Blow tests the strongest counter-view
18:00–20:00	What Now? — the action; thank-you; subscribe + newsletter CTA

Capture for clips: the editor flags 3–5 standalone moments live (timestamp + one-line hook) so cutting starts immediately.

Post-production handoff (the clip pipeline)

Clips are the highest-leverage output — treat as an SLA (07).

- ☐ **≥6 clips/day** total across both segments, vertical, **captioned**, branded template
- ☐ Each clip: 2-second hook · one complete idea · ends on subscribe/clip CTA
- ☐ **Daily Read** note drafted from the Live take (→ Substack/LinkedIn/IG)
- ☐ **Quote of the Day** graphic from the Evening Show
- ☐ Episode published with title, thumbnail, chapters, pinned "What Now?" + newsletter link
- ☐ Clips **scheduled** across platforms per the calendar (09)

End-of-day close (7:00)

- ☐ Both segments published ☒ / community thread posted
- ☐ Reply to top comments on YouTube + IG (community is retention)
- ☐ **Set tomorrow's call sheet** (fill the template below)
- ☐ Confirm tomorrow's guest + tech-check time
- ☐ Top up the **bank** — is there ≥1 evergreen Evening Show in reserve?

Contingency playbook

IF...	THEN...
Stream drops mid-Live	Cut to evergreen fallback; reconnect via hotspot; resume or post recap
Guest cancels	Pull a banked Evening Show ; never go dark. (This is why we keep a reserve.)
Breaking news mid-day	Lunch Break Live pivots entirely; Evening Show can become a rapid-reaction solo
Audio failure	Switch to backup recording; worst case, ship audio-only + captions
Editor out	Auto-tool (Opus/Descript) first-pass clips; host picks moments; reduce to 3 clips



DAILY CALL SHEET (copy & fill each morning)

THE CHARLES BLOW SHOW – DAILY CALL SHEET

Date: _____ Day #: _____ Producer on point: _____

WEATHER OF THE DAY (the news)

Top story: _____

Blow's angle: _____

☀ LUNCH BREAK LIVE – GO LIVE @ _____ (tech check @ -30)

Segment beats: ☐ The Receipts ☐ The Throughline ☐ Other: _____

Live producer: _____ Chat mod: _____

Stream targets: ☐ YouTube ☐ _____ Backup internet: ☐ ready

Must-watch-for clip moment: _____

🌙 THE EVENING SHOW – RECORD @ _____ PUBLISH @ _____

Guest: _____ Title: _____

Topic: _____

Anchor Qs: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

Devil's Advocate angle: _____

What Now? action: _____

Tech check @ _____ ☐ Riverside ready ☐ backup audio

☐ Using BANKED episode instead (id: _____)

CLIP TARGETS (≥6)

From Live: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

From Evening: 4) _____ 5) _____ 6) _____

WRITTEN

☐ Daily Read note ☐ Quote of the Day ☐ Column (Fri only)

PUBLISH CHECKLIST

☐ Live replay up ☐ Evening Show up (title/thumb/chapters)

☐ Clips scheduled ☐ Newsletter slot ☐ Community thread

RESERVE STATUS

Banked Evening Shows on hand: _____ ☐ need to record one

NOTES / RISKS

